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Unit 1 - Exploring the Core

PDF Documents

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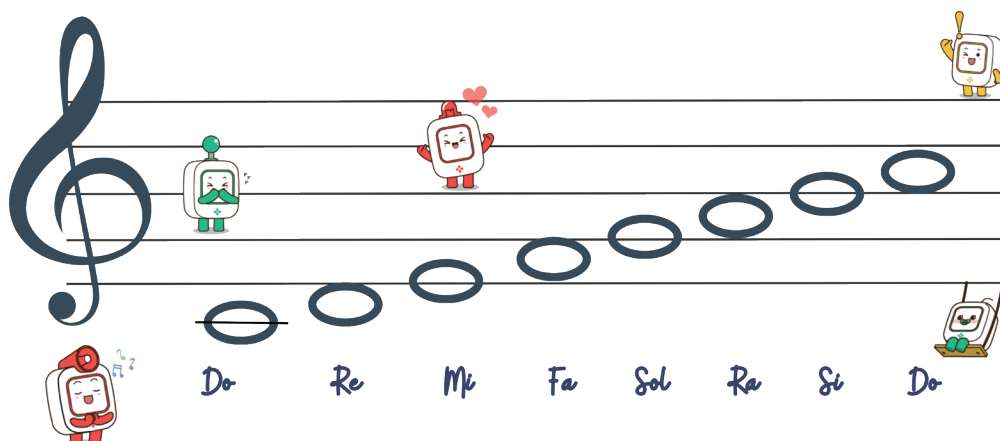
UNIT 1 EXPLORING THE CORE

Topic Investigation



THE ESSENCE OF MUSIC SCALES AND THE DIGITAL EVOLUTION

In music, scales like the C Major scale, which goes Do-Re-Mi-Fa-Sol-La-Ti-Do, are like the alphabet for making tunes. These scales have always been played on instruments like pianos, guitars, and flutes, creating beautiful sounds that fill the air. This kind of music is called analog music because it flows smoothly, just like how water flows in a river, carrying the special touch of the musician directly to our ears.



But now, we also have digital music, which is a bit like building with blocks. Instead of smooth waves of sound, digital music uses tiny steps or blocks of sound that computers can understand. This change is something you might have noticed in how we listen to music today—like using smartphones or computers instead of record players. With digital music, we can use computers to make all kinds of sounds, even without traditional instruments.

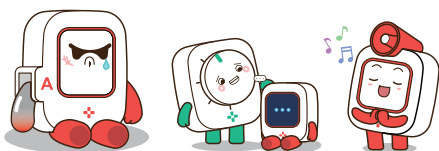


Questioning the Details

HOW IS DIGITAL MUSIC CREATED?

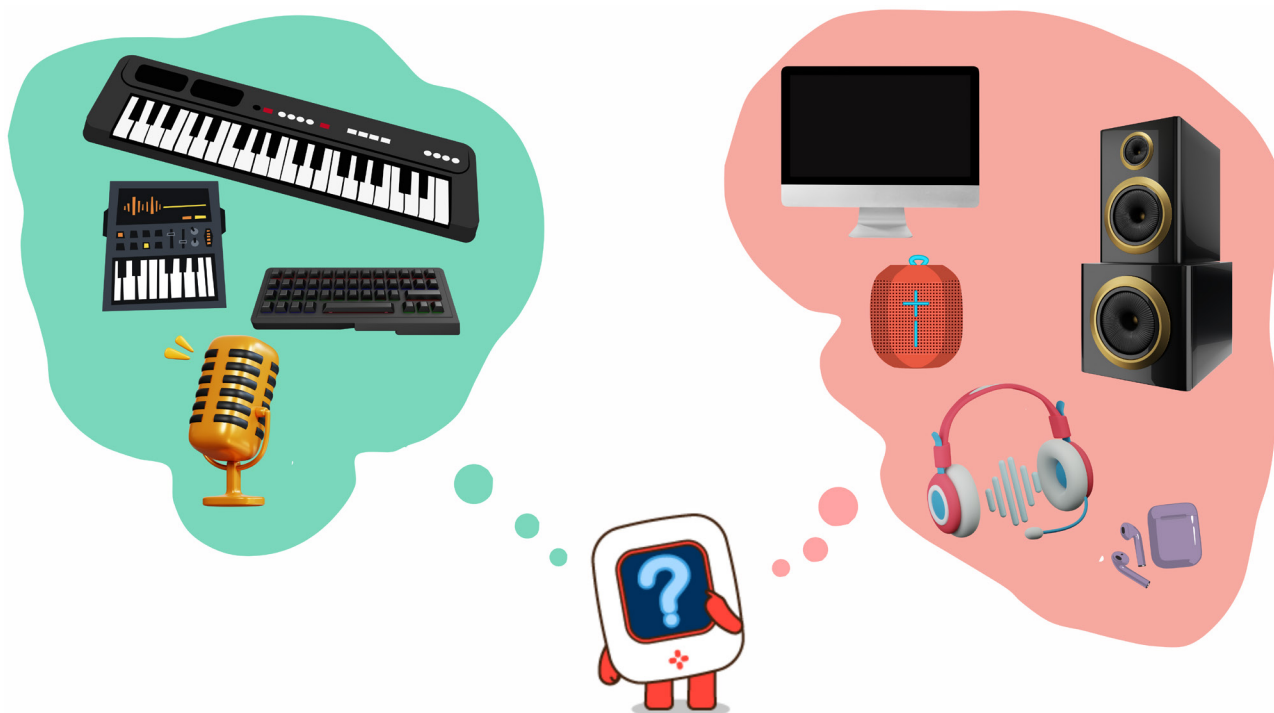
Digital music relies on electronic devices that transform digital signals into audible sounds. This transformation is achieved through sound synthesis, a process where software or hardware generates audio signals.

These signals can emulate the sounds of traditional instruments or create entirely new, unique sounds. Unlike acoustic instruments, where sound is produced through physical means like vibrating strings or air columns, digital instruments produce sound by manipulating binary data in real-time, offering vast possibilities for sonic exploration.



DEVICES FOR DIGITAL MUSIC?

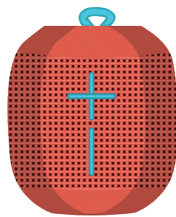
In the image above, you can see various devices on the desk. Why do you think we need these devices to produce digital music? Reflecting on the input and output concepts we studied in previous chapters will help you answer this question easily.





INPUT DEVICES FOR DIGITAL MUSIC

- A **microphone** can catch the sounds of your voice or an acoustic guitar, turning them into digital signals the computer understands.
- A **MIDI (Musical Instrument Digital Interface) keyboard** looks like a piano but sends information about which keys are pressed and how hard, to the computer.
- Even **digital drums or a guitar** with a special connection can tell the computer the rhythms and melodies you play.
- Sometimes, **musicians record sounds** from the world around us—like the chirping of birds or the rumble of a train—using a recorder. These real-world sounds can then be transformed into digital sounds through the computer.
- There are much more input devices for digital music. Even a simple keyboard can be an input device to produce digital music.



OUTPUT DEVICES FOR DIGITAL MUSIC

- **Speakers and headphones** are like the book or screen for our story, turning the digital signals back into sounds we can enjoy.
- For a live performance, the digital music might be sent to an **amplifier** and then through big **loudspeakers** so everyone in a room or a concert hall can hear the music.
- Monitors are crucial output devices for digital music because they allow producers to visually manage and adjust audio tracks for optimal sound quality.



Inquiry & Reflection

Discussion question 1

Can you think of a situation where digital music might be more useful than analog music?

Discussion question 2

Why do you think people still choose to listen to live orchestras in person, even though they can listen to digital music at home?